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Myo Reps Part 2

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This is the google translated version, with changes made by me only when google couldn't find the right words (not that I can read Norwegian, but because I can understand physiology and make a good guess at what Borge meant). Any mistakes in translation or understanding are entirely mine.

You can find the original page in Norwegian [here](http://myrevolution.no/myo-reps-del-2-revolusjonen-fortsetter-treningsmengde/)
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[Myo-reps Part 2 - The revolution continues - Amount of Training](#)

We looked at the theoretical and practical basis for Myo-reps in Part 1. Now we look at the guidelines for training volume, or total number of repetitions for a given load, and how you, with a unique and effective method, can adjust this on an ongoing basis in the training session!

"How many sets / reps?" Is probably one of the most common questions I hear. In addition to the "why banner Northerner you so much?".

There is probably no right or wrong on this - either the first or second question, but we can still make some educated guesses on the first. I have based myself on the excellent and comprehensive study of Wernbom that I talked about in the [first part](#), in short 20-30 total reps, up to 40-60 total reps, 2-3 times a week. I then combined it with the experiences of effective programs with similar exercise frequency (yes, I see that is completely away from typical Coleman / Arnold bodybuilding) applications, such as [DC](#), 5 × 5, [HST](#) (and RYP, which was based on the latter) .

For those who remember a few years back, we had also høyfrekvensprogrammene [George: I've no idea what this actually is, but a good guess would be a training programme] Serious Growth and Bulgarian Burst, which I accidentally started my own training career (reminisce reminisce).

In many studies and applications of muscle mass is the area of 8-12 reps going again. Now, remember only that a muscle can not count, so the background for this recommendation is more related to the weights are heavy enough to provide the necessary stimulus to the muscle, yet light enough to give the required time under load (total reps) without that the tendons, joints and nervous system becomes overloaded.

We also know that when you do too much, it actually gives worse results than doing too little. It's not like 4 sets gives rise twice as good as 2 sets, but rather a few percent extra - which in turn must be balanced against the recovery time increases dramatically the more stress you inflict on the body. It is better to be a bit conservative and make sure you are recovered for the next training session - something very few of the hardcore guys fail to realize, unfortunately.

BUT, an important factor comes in here. When several of the training programs that traditionally used for muscle mass execution set for example 8-10 reps, and with the criterion for optimal fiber activation as I mentioned in Part 1, it is against the last reps of a set we have so-called "effective" reps with the maximum [training effect](#) on all muscle fibers. When you rest for 2-3 minutes before taking the next set, you set about "starting again", even though full activation is reached faster due to accumulated fatigue from the previous set.

Let me illustrate a "standard" protocol of 3 sets of 10 reps, and I select the "effective" reps near maximum fiber activation with sign *

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 * 9 * 10 *

pause of 2 min

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 * 8 * 9 *

break 2min

1 2 3 4 5 6 * 7 * 8 *

We have therefore run 27 reps total, 9 of which are "effective" reps at full fiber activation. In real terms the number will probably be higher, but by illustrating it this way, we can deduce that we need about 5-15, maybe up to 20 "effective" reps for maximum training effect based on the estimates above.

Let us compare with Myo-reps:

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 * 9 * (we stop here because the reps speed begins to drop noticeably).

break of 10-15 sec

1 * 2 * 3 *

break of 10-15 sec

1 * 2 * 3 * (No. 3 reps started to get heavy)

(Slightly longer) break 20sek

1 * 2 * 3 *

break 20sek

1 * 2 * (you would not have reps No. 3 and stops here).

Do you see the difference? Because of the short break ALL the reps after the first set were effective, and we drove a total of 10 reps. We use, as you probably remember from Part 1, the notation 9 + 11 (or 9 + 3 3 3 2) where the number in front of reps + sets reps on the activation set, and the figure behind the + stands for "efficient" split reps in such short series with a short break between.

With about 3 seconds per reps we have, with Myo-reps, only spent a total of 140 seconds, or 2 minutes and 20 seconds, from start to finish, where the example of "regular" sets uses 5 minutes and 20 seconds.

To what extent, density (total number of reps performed per unit time) plays a role in the training effect, we know not yet with certainty. There are some indications that suggest that a higher density provides a better stimulus, and can therefore be twice as high or higher in Myo-reps!

Heavier loads require fewer reps after the + sign because we are near the maximum fiber activation from the first rep. Light loads require more, because the real power per fiber unit is lower, and one must therefore allow the load "real" on the muscle over time to compensate. We must also take into account that there will be positive with more rest before the training phase in order to have the energy to run heavily in the end, so one should strive to keep the number after the + sign in the same area throughout the training phase.[George: I think what Borge is saying here is that a small increase in breaks throughout the 'myo rep' collection of sets will ensure that your 'activated reps' will stay the same number. So as you get more tired, you rest a little longer to ensure you get the same number of reps out in each 'activated set'.]

My general guidelines are:

+15-30 [15-30 'activated reps'] when you have only one exercise for one muscle group, for priority groups of muscles, when you train with lighter weights, or simply have a higher volume tolerance.

+10-20 when you have two exercises for one muscle group, or have a moderate volume tolerance.

+5-15 on isolation exercises or smaller muscle groups when you already have trained 1-2 base lift or overlapping exercises when lifting very heavy weights, or if, for various reasons, have lower exercise tolerance.

How can we make this even more precise in relation to our own assumptions?

Exhaustion Point

When we work with our body, a system in motion that continuously adapts to the stress that is applied, most of the dose-response recommendations (how many sets, reps, exercises) can only be educated guesses and there is no blueprint for what is optimal for just YOU, your exercise tolerance, your stress level, activity level, diet, and not least, your goals and priorities. A standard training program that you find on the internet or in a fitness magazine will ONLY be as effective as the degree that it matches your current circumstances.

We must do something! To control the amount of exercise for each exercise from exercise to exercise, it would be invaluable to have a method on an ongoing basis that can tell you whether you have recovered enough from the previous exercise, and how many sets and reps that are required to obtain the necessary training effect .

One such method is the so-called Rating of Perceived Effort (RPE), which is a subjective assessment of how hard

you have to exert yourself to complete a task.

It runs on a scale of 1-10, but in practice we use mostly 7-10 where 5-6 is only for the warmup.

10 is the absolute maximum lift (you would not have another one without help)

9 will say that you could do one of the reps, but not 2

8 is about 2-3 reps in reserve

7 is very easy and explosive and you could do 3-4 reps more.

Coaches and athletes at the elite level using this system, either consciously or unconsciously. For those who are into powerlifting, Mike Tuchscherer has developed his [Reactive Training System](#) based on different implementations of the RPE, a training system which has made him the top ranked USAPL powerlifter, and the winner of this year's Arnold Classic. Those who have followed this system have had some impressive increases.

Recent studies also confirm that this is a sufficiently accurate method to evaluate where you are in training response-recovery curve, that is, if your training volume and intensity is in the correct balance of how often you exercise.

I have further developed this line of thinking and using terminology Exhaustion Point:

The first set is called the activation set and aims to reach full activation of the muscle fiber. Therefore you must exercise fairly close to exhaustion, that is, if you had pushed you, you would clear a rep to - but not two, to illustrate what I mean. Do not push you until you need help to lift the weight. [George: Your goal is to reach your max, a point where to get another rep you would need a spotter to help you].

This figure is BEFORE + sign. Let us take an example:

9-12 x 3

I.E. 9-12 reps on the activation set. Whether there will be 8 or 13 reps plays virtually no role, you will then either use the same weight next time or increase the weight next time to get into the proper reps area - it is not necessary to include a new set and reduce / increase the weight. Muscle is not so sensitive to a rep from or to this area, even if you are. [George: You have a rep range target, not a specific number, because your body doesn't count, it just experiences the stimulus].

After the activating set of 9-12 reps, set up the weight [rack the weight] and breathe deeply 10 times (equivalent to about 20 seconds of rest). As you continue to run a short series of reps, for example, 3 reps (this varies based on how heavy the weight is), close to exhaustion. You should all be able to balance this point of exhaustion - it's tiring but still it should be explosive. Rest breaks (number of breaths) will be shorter for light weights, and longer (several breaths) on the heavier weights. Each deep breath + exhalation is regarded as a breath.

So 3 x means that you can use 3 reps on Myo-reps series of activation set, until you can not manage 3 reps more.

Remember that you must run the same weight load on the activation set and the Myo-reps range.

Let's say you manage 10 +3 +3 +3 +3 (each is 10 + breathing break) and on the last series was a repetition 3 very heavy (you could do one but not two). You have reached a fatigue point and now you should STOP the exercise.

Total number of reps in the figure AFTER + sign, and if you count up, the 10 (active) 12 (series of 3 reps, rest, 3 reps, pause, etc.). You write down the weight you used, 12 and 10 in your training log, for example. 50kg x 10 reps 12.

It can of course also be that you stop at 1 or 2 reps on the last series and fail on 3 repetition, which is also okay. You will now see that the number of reps in Myo-reps series will vary from exercise to exercise and day to day. This is what makes Myo-reps efficient, it means you avoid exercising too much (or too little), the amount of exercise will always suit your strength increases and your daily form.

Auto-regulation it is called, and you find an article about this [here](#) [in Norwegian and [here in English](#)]

It is better to take it easy on days you're in bad shape, and then come back stronger next time, so do not think of it

as a failure if you did 12 last time in, and only six this time. Think rather long-term progression of a balance between the amount of exercise and recovery. Far better than driving 100% every workout and then meet the famous Mr Wall after a few weeks.

When you lift weights for 20-25 reps area you can drive 5 reps per set, and 5 breathing pause between each series, I.E. 25 + 5 + 5 + 5 (+ means each break). When you come in heavier weights for 6-8 reps area is perhaps only 1 or 2 reps in each set, that is, 6 +1 +1 +1 +1 or 8 +2 +2 +2, and 15-20 breaths break (30 - 40 seconds). We return to the guidelines for each area reps later.

It is also rare that you need to run more than two exercises on the same muscle group each workout with Myo-reps. If you want variety, consider a so-called non-linear setup with different reps each workout areas, and different exercises that are suitable to the area reps. It does not require many different exercises to stimulate the muscle to get bigger and stronger, it's pretty easy that way and respond to the degree of tension / stress and how long it is exposed to this through the sets and reps. [George: If you want to do more than one exercise per body part then use a different rep range for your succeeding exercises.]

Okay, you managed 11+10 on the bench press, but only 9+5 on the shoulder press, ran on 10+12 chin-ups and finished with 14+22 seated rowing. It appears that you have stimulated the spinal muscles better than the chest / shoulders for such a session, but think rather that the chest / shoulders did not need as much stimulation to achieve the desired training effect today. On the back muscles working you may not be close enough to exhaustion, and thus were compensated automatically by the fact that you managed more total reps. Less fatigue = more reps, more fatigue limits the number of reps and sets. What is best?

Over the longer term it probably plays a big role, you must certainly lift heavy weights and train hard, but it's a big misconception to have any association between the walker and the life-passing-in-revue after a workout and great results. It is rather the opposite, the best progress can be experienced during periods when you go home from training with the feeling of being able to do more. [George: Over the long term it seems to be better to leave a little in the tank, rather than walking out of the gym exhausted and beaten every time.]

So - instead of being depressed that you had a bad day, from now on you end your session in the knowledge that you have stimulated the muscle just the right amount, and when you come to training next time you will usually do more reps , heavier weights, or both.

The guidelines are:

20-25 reps - 5 reps on Myo-reps series, 2-5 breathing pause - notation 20-25 5 x

15-20 reps - 5 reps on Myo-reps range, 5-10 breath pause - notation 15-20 5 x

12-15 reps - 4 reps on Myo-reps range, 5-10 breath pause - notation 12-15 4 x

9-12 reps - 3 reps on Myo-reps range, 10-15 breaths break - notation 9.12 x 3

6-9 reps - 1 or 2 reps on Myo-reps range, 15-20 breaths break - Notation 6.9 or 2 x 9.6 x 1 - in this area, we begin, however, to come up on the weights that have full fiber activation first repetition, and we can start thinking of other principles of auto-regulation of the amount of exercise, with longer rest intervals between sets. Read the [article on auto-regulation](#) (and [again in English](#))

Before you start to memorize the table and hang you up in whether you should take 2 reps 4 reps here or there, let me emphasize that this is the ONLY practical guidelines for making Myo-reps easy to implement, and no ultimate answer.

You need to adjust this on an ongoing basis when you're at the gym too. If you are running 4 x 12-15 and about to continue in perpetuity with 10 breathing pause, then the problem is one or more of the following:

- You trained not close enough to exhaustion on the activation set
- You have too a long breather, take 5-6 instead of 10 breaths.
- You are not close enough to the point of exhaustion with running a series of only 4 reps, then try with 5 or 6 reps instead.

The point is to balance the point of exhaustion in order to achieve maximum fiber activation, and then get a high

enough amount of exercise by the selected strain, with an explosive finish.

A variation is for example to run the activation set followed by a series of activated reps with only 1-2 breathing pause between each rep, for example, exercises such as leg press where you can relieve the muscle by simply stretch my knees out and breathing (without putting the safety stop) or sidehev [lat raise?] and biceps curl where you can rest by letting your arms hang straight down. This is very similar to Dan Moore's Max Stimulation.

I can certainly promise you that you will feel it deep inside muscles, both one and two days after a workout with Myo-reps, in a completely different way than you've ever known before!

A method is only as effective as the underlying progression - for we can say with certainty that you can not only increase the number of repetitions or exercises in perpetuity - sooner or later you MUST also increase the load you lift. In part 3 we will therefore look at the last but most important factor, namely the progression model I recommend for Myo-reps method. ...

Børge A. Fagerli

MyRevolution Coach Team

Thanks for Borge for that, you can also see more of his articles on this site here (Parts [1](#), [2](#), [3](#), [4](#)). You can see some of my training programs [here](#).

And now you can get some free coaching for YOUR myo-reps journey. Just fill in the form below and we will get started!

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